

DIGITAL MARKETING | MODULE 4

SEO

Search Engine Optimization

From how search engines work to on-page, off-page and link building, with hands-on practicals.

Prepared by Soham Kore

Disha Computer Institute | Disha Group



Module Roadmap

1

How search engines work

2

SEO basics

3

On-page optimization

4

Off-page optimization

5

Do-follow vs no-follow links

6

Backlinks

7

Link building techniques

8

Off-page SEO practicals

9

Guest posting

Learning Outcomes

- Explain how crawling, indexing and ranking work
- Optimize a web page for a target keyword
- Find and build quality backlinks
- Tell do-follow from no-follow links in HTML
- Use free tools to track results



By the end of this module you can run a basic SEO campaign using free tools.

What is a Search Engine?

- **Definition:** software that finds, ranks and shows web pages for what a user types (the query).
- **Examples:** Google, Bing, Yahoo, DuckDuckGo, Yandex, Baidu.
- **Why it matters:** most online journeys start with a search, so a high rank means free, high-intent visitors.
- **Output:** a SERP (Search Engine Results Page), delivered in under a second.



~90%

of global searches happen on Google

The 3 Stages of a Search Engine



STAGE 1

Crawling

Bots discover pages by following links from page to page.



STAGE 2

Indexing

Content is analyzed and stored in a giant database called the index.



STAGE 3

Ranking

The best matches for a query are picked and ordered on the results page.

Remember crawling and indexing happen in advance; ranking happens in milliseconds when you search.

Stage 1: Crawling



Googlebot (the spider)

An automated program that follows links from page to page to find new and updated content.



How pages are found

Links from other pages, XML sitemaps submitted in Search Console, and direct URL submission.



Key terms

Crawl budget: pages Google will crawl on your site. robots.txt: tells bots what not to crawl. XML sitemap: a list of your URLs.



What blocks crawling

Broken links, robots.txt or noindex blocks, login walls, very slow servers and heavy JavaScript.

Stage 2: Indexing

- **What happens:** Google reads text, images, video, titles and meta tags, then stores a processed copy in its index.
- **Not everything is indexed:** duplicate, thin or low-quality pages may be skipped.
- **Canonical tag:** tells Google which URL is the main version when similar pages exist.
- **Noindex tag:** keeps a page out of results on purpose (e.g. thank-you pages).
- **Check it:** Search Console, URL Inspection shows whether a page is indexed.



Crawled does not always mean indexed.

Stage 3: Ranking



Relevance

How well the page matches the meaning of the query.



Content quality (E-E-A-T)

Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust: shown by author info and sources.



Backlinks

Links from trusted sites act as votes of confidence.



Page experience

Fast loading (Core Web Vitals), stable layout, HTTPS.



Mobile-friendliness

Google indexes the mobile version of your site first.



Location and personalization

Results change by place, language and search history.

Search intent informational (learn) • navigational (find a site) • commercial (compare) • transactional (buy)

Anatomy of a SERP



Paid ads

Marked "Sponsored"; pay per click.



Organic results

Free listings ranked by SEO.



Featured snippet

Answer box at the very top.



People Also Ask

Expandable related questions.



Local pack

Map with 3 nearby businesses.



Images and video

Visual results for the query.



AI Overviews

AI summary with source links.



Knowledge panel

Info box on a brand or person.

Activity search "best computer institute in Pune" and label every element you can see.

See It Yourself

- **site:** shows the pages Google has indexed for a domain.
- **intitle: / inurl:** finds pages with a word in the title or URL.
- **"quotes"** match an exact phrase in order.
- **URL Inspection:** Search Console, paste a URL and see its index status.

TYPE THESE IN GOOGLE

```
site:dishagroup.in
```

```
site:dishagroup.in excel
```

```
intitle:"digital marketing course"
```

```
inurl:blog "SEO tips"
```

```
"advanced excel course" pune
```

What is SEO?

- **Definition:** improving a website so it appears higher in unpaid (organic) search results.
- **SEM:** Search Engine Marketing = SEO + paid ads (Google Ads).
- **SEO vs paid ads:** SEO is slower but traffic keeps flowing; paid is instant but stops when the budget stops.
- **Benefits:** sustained traffic, credibility, low cost per lead, 24/7 visibility.



3-6 mo

typical time before SEO results
become visible

Types of SEO



On-page SEO

Content, HTML tags, structure and speed on your own pages.



Off-page SEO

Backlinks, mentions and trust signals from other sites.



Technical SEO

Crawlability, site speed, mobile, HTTPS and site structure.



Local SEO

Google Business Profile, reviews and local citations.



Content SEO

Creating helpful content around keywords and search intent.



Our focus today

A deep dive into on-page and off-page SEO.

Keywords: The Foundation



Short-tail: "excel"

- High search volume
- Very high competition
- Unclear intent
- Hard for a new site to rank
- Example: "excel course"



Long-tail: "excel course in pune"

- Lower volume
- Lower competition
- Clear intent: ready to enrol
- Easier to rank and converts better
- Example: "advanced excel course in pune with certification"

Check 3 numbers search volume • keyword difficulty • search intent

Keyword Research

1

Pick a seed keyword

Start with a core topic, e.g.
"Python course".

2

Find variations

Use Autosuggest, Keyword Planner and AnswerThePublic to list 10+ ideas with volume and difficulty.

3

Choose and map

Pick 1 primary and 3-5 secondary keywords per page and match each to its intent.

Tools Google Keyword Planner • Google Trends • Ubersuggest • AnswerThePublic • Google Autosuggest

SEO Hats



White hat

Ethical: quality content, genuine links, follows Google guidelines. Safe and lasting results.



Grey hat

Risky shortcuts in a grey zone, e.g. aggressive outreach or buying expired domains. May be penalized later.



Black hat

Breaks guidelines: keyword stuffing, cloaking, link farms, PBNs. Leads to penalties or removal from Google.

We practise white-hat SEO only penalties can wipe out your traffic overnight.

SEO Tools Overview

Tool	Free or paid	What it does
Google Search Console	Free	Indexing, search queries, links and errors
Google Analytics 4	Free	Traffic, user behaviour and conversions
Yoast SEO / Rank Math	Free and paid	On-page checks inside WordPress
PageSpeed Insights	Free	Speed and Core Web Vitals report
Screaming Frog	Free (500 URLs) and paid	Site crawler for technical audits
Ahrefs / Semrush / Moz	Paid (limited free tools)	Keywords, backlinks and competitor research

What is On-Page SEO?

Everything you control on the page itself.



Content

Helpful, original and matched to search intent.



HTML elements

Title, meta description, headings and alt text.



Structure

Clean URLs, internal links and schema markup.



Experience

Fast, mobile-friendly and secure (HTTPS).

Title Tag and Meta Description

- **Title tag:** 50-60 characters, primary keyword near the front, brand at the end.
- **Meta description:** 150-160 characters, benefit-led, with a call to action. Not a direct ranking factor, but it lifts clicks (CTR).
- **Why it matters:** this is the headline and blurb people see in the SERP.

HTML: BAD VS GOOD

```
<!-- BAD -->
<title>Home</title>
<meta name="description"
  content="Welcome to our site">

<!-- GOOD -->
<title>Advanced Excel Course in
  Dehugaon | Disha Institute</title>
<meta name="description"
  content="Learn Excel with live
  projects
  and certification. Enrol today!">
```

Headings and Content Quality

- **One H1:** contains the primary keyword.
- **Logical order:** H2 for sections, H3 for sub-points. Do not skip levels for styling.
- **Keyword use:** in the first 100 words, naturally. No stuffing.
- **Quality:** original, helpful, matches search intent, kept up to date.

HEADING HIERARCHY

```
H1: Advanced Excel Course
H2: What You Will Learn
H3: Formulas and Functions
H3: Pivot Tables
H3: Dashboards
H2: Course Fees and Duration
H2: Why Join Disha?
H2: Frequently Asked Questions
```

URLs, Images and Internal Links



Clean URLs

Short, readable, lowercase and keyword-rich. Avoid IDs and random characters.



Images

Descriptive file name, alt text, compressed WebP and lazy loading for speed.



Internal links

Link related pages with descriptive anchor text (not "click here") to pass authority.

URL example Good: /advanced-excel-course Bad: /page?id=382

Technical On-Page Factors



Core Web Vitals

LCP under 2.5s (loading), INP under 200ms (response), CLS under 0.1 (stability).



Mobile-friendly

Google indexes the mobile version first. Use responsive design.



HTTPS

The padlock builds trust and is a light ranking signal.



Schema markup

Structured data (JSON-LD) can earn rich results like stars and FAQs.



Canonical tags

Point duplicate or similar pages to one main URL.



XML sitemap

Lists important URLs so crawlers find them quickly.

On-Page Audit with Yoast / Rank Math

1

Install the plugin

WordPress, Plugins, Add New: install Yoast SEO or Rank Math and activate it.

2

Set a focus keyword

Enter the primary keyword for the page in the plugin box.

3

Fix red and orange items

Improve title, meta description, headings, alt text and keyword use.

4

Test the speed

Run the URL in PageSpeed Insights and fix big images and slow scripts.

5

Request indexing

Search Console, URL Inspection, then Request Indexing.



Before vs after

Compare score screenshots and discuss what changed.

On-Page SEO Checklist



Primary keyword in title, H1, URL and first 100 words



Title 50-60 characters, meta description 150-160



One H1 and a logical H2/H3 structure



Original content that matches search intent



Descriptive alt text on every image



Compressed images and fast load (Core Web Vitals)



Internal links with descriptive anchor text



Mobile-friendly and served over HTTPS



Canonical tag and schema where relevant



Page submitted in Search Console

What is Off-Page SEO?

Everything you do outside your website to build authority, trust and relevance.



Authority

How strong and well known your site is, mostly built through quality backlinks.



Trust

Reviews, brand mentions and consistent business details show you are legitimate.



Relevance

Links and mentions from sites in your niche confirm what your site is about.

Off-Page vs On-Page SEO

Aspect	On-Page SEO	Off-Page SEO
Where	Inside your website	Outside your website
Control	Full control	Partial: depends on other sites
Examples	Titles, headings, content, speed, internal links	Backlinks, guest posts, citations, reviews, mentions
Main goal	Relevance and user experience	Authority and trust
Tools	Yoast / Rank Math, PageSpeed, Screaming Frog	Ahrefs, Moz, Ubersuggest, Search Console
Speed of results	Faster	Slower and ongoing

Off-Page Activities



Backlinks

Links from other sites: the strongest signal.



Social signals

Shares and engagement that drive traffic and awareness.



Brand mentions

Your name mentioned online, even without a link.



Local citations

Listings with consistent name, address and phone.



Guest posting

Articles on other sites with a link back.



Influencer outreach

Creators and experts sharing your content.



Online reviews

Google and Justdial reviews build trust.



Digital PR

News features and press mentions.

Link Attributes Explained



Do-follow (default)

A normal link. Passes "link equity" (ranking value) to the page it points to.



rel="nofollow"

Tells Google not to treat the link as an endorsement. Passes little or no equity.



rel="sponsored"

For paid links, ads and affiliate links, as Google guidelines require.



rel="ugc"

For user-generated content such as blog comments and forum posts.

Good to know Google treats these attributes as hints, not strict commands.

Do-Follow vs No-Follow in HTML

- **Do-follow:** no rel attribute needed. It is a normal link.
- **No-follow:** add rel="nofollow" inside the <a> tag.
- **Combine:** rel="nofollow sponsored" is allowed.

HTML

```
<!-- Do-follow (default) -->  
<a href="https://dishagroup.in">  
  Disha Group  
</a>
```

```
<!-- No-follow -->  
<a href="https://dishagroup.in"  
  rel="nofollow">  
  Disha Group  
</a>
```

```
<!-- Sponsored / user-generated -->  
<a href="..." rel="sponsored">  
<a href="..." rel="ugc">
```

Check a Link's Type

1

Inspect the link

Right-click a link, choose Inspect and look for `rel="nofollow"` in the `<a>` tag.

2

Use an extension

Install a NoFollow Chrome extension: no-follow links are highlighted on the page.

3

Compare sites

Check outbound links on Wikipedia, Quora and a news site, and record the results.

Class activity build a table with three columns: Site, Link location, Do-follow or no-follow.

Which Should You Want?



Do-follow links

- Pass ranking value (link equity)
- Best when from relevant, trusted sites
- Strongest for building authority



No-follow links

- Bring referral traffic and brand exposure
- Make your link profile look natural
- Google may still use them as a hint

Healthy profile a natural mix of both. Only do-follow links looks suspicious.

What are Backlinks?

- **Definition:** a link from another website to yours (also called an inbound link).
- **Why they matter:** Google treats them as votes of confidence: one of its strongest ranking signals.
- **Quality factors:** relevance of the linking site, its authority, anchor text and link placement.
- **Anchor text:** the clickable words. Natural and descriptive beats "click here" or spammy exact-match text.
- **Referring domains:** the number of unique sites linking to you.



1 > 100

one link from a trusted, relevant site
can beat 100 spammy ones

Good vs Bad Backlinks



Good backlinks

- From relevant sites in your niche
- Editorial: earned by useful content
- From trusted domains (news, education, industry blogs)
- Natural, varied anchor text



Bad backlinks

- Link farms and PBNs
- Paid link schemes
- Spammy comments and irrelevant sites
- Bulk profile and forum spam

Toxic links? ask for removal first. Use the Disavow tool only as a last resort.

Analyze Backlinks

1

Enter a competitor URL

Paste a competing institute into a free backlink checker.

2

Read the report

Note total backlinks, referring domains and top linking pages.

3

Spot opportunities

List 5 sites that link to competitors and could link to you.

4

Check your own links

Search Console, Links report shows who links to your site.

Tools Ahrefs Backlink Checker • Moz Link Explorer • Ubersuggest • Search Console

Link Building Overview

- **What it is:** the process of getting other websites to link to yours.
- **Principle:** earn links with useful content and genuine outreach.
- **Beginner techniques (today):** social bookmarking, Q&A sites, image submission, directory submission.
- **Advanced (later):** guest posting, digital PR, broken-link building, resource pages.
- **Watch out:** links from low-quality bulk sites can hurt more than they help.



Earn links, do not spam them. Value first, link second.

Technique 1: Social Bookmarking

WHAT IT IS

Saving and sharing web pages on public bookmarking sites so others can discover them.

POPULAR PLATFORMS

Mix • Diigo • Pearltrees • Flipboard

LINK TYPE AND VALUE

Mostly no-follow. Value: traffic, faster discovery and brand exposure.

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Create a complete profile with a logo and website link.
- 2 Bookmark your page with a keyword-rich title, short description and tags.
- 3 Share and engage: also bookmark other useful pages, not only your own.

Avoid bulk-submitting to hundreds of sites. Use quality platforms only.

Technique 2: Q&A Sites

WHAT IT IS

Answering real questions on communities where your target audience asks for help.

POPULAR PLATFORMS

Quora • Reddit • Stack Exchange

LINK TYPE AND VALUE

Mostly no-follow. Value: targeted traffic, credibility and brand awareness.

HOW TO DO IT

1

Search questions in your niche, e.g. "best course to learn Excel".

2

Write a genuinely helpful, detailed answer first.

3

Add your link only where it truly helps, and disclose your affiliation.

Rules no spam, follow each community guidelines, never paste the same answer twice.

Technique 3: Image Submission

WHAT IT IS

Sharing original images, infographics and visuals on image sites with a link back to your page.

POPULAR PLATFORMS

Pinterest • Flickr • Behance • Imgur

LINK TYPE AND VALUE

Mostly no-follow. Value: traffic, image-search visibility and shares.

HOW TO DO IT

1

Create an infographic or visual (Canva works well).

2

Add a descriptive title, tags, description and alt text.

3

Upload and add your page URL as the source link.

Remember use original visuals only. Never upload copyrighted images.

Technique 4: Directory Submission

WHAT IT IS

Listing your business in online directories and map platforms.

POPULAR PLATFORMS

Google Business Profile • Bing Places • Justdial • Sulekha • IndiaMART

LINK TYPE AND VALUE

Link type varies. Local listings boost Maps visibility and trust.

HOW TO DO IT

1

Pick trusted, relevant directories (local and niche).

2

Fill every field. Keep NAP (Name, Address, Phone) identical everywhere.

3

Add categories, photos and website link, then verify the listing.

Avoid low-quality bulk directories: they look spammy.

Practical Lab Plan

1

Google Business Profile

Create it and complete every section: category, hours, photos, services.

2

Social bookmarking

Set up 3 profiles and submit one page of the institute.

3

Q&A answers

Answer 3 relevant Quora questions helpfully, without spamming.

4

Image submission

Pin one infographic on Pinterest with title, tags and link.

5

Directories

Submit the business to 2 trusted directories with matching NAP.

6

Tracking sheet

Log date, platform, URL, link type and status for every task.

Tracking and Measuring

Where to look	What to check
Google Search Console	Links report, queries, impressions, clicks and indexing
Google Analytics 4	Referral traffic and which pages visitors land on
Ahrefs / Moz	New backlinks, referring domains and authority score
Your tracking sheet	Status of every submission and follow-up date

Key metrics referring domains • keyword rankings • organic traffic • conversions (enquiries, admissions)

What is Guest Posting?



STEP 1

You write

Create a valuable, original article for a website in your niche.



STEP 2

They publish

The host site reviews it and shares it with its audience.



STEP 3

You earn

Exposure, referral traffic and a contextual backlink.

Example a Pune education blog publishes your article "5 Excel Skills Every Accountant Needs".

Benefits and Risks



Benefits

- Authority in your niche
- Referral traffic
- Contextual backlinks
- Relationships and networking



Risks

- Google warns against large-scale guest posting done mainly for links
- Paid or low-quality blogs can harm you
- Thin or duplicate content
- Time-consuming

Paid or sponsored post? use rel="nofollow" or rel="sponsored" on the link.

Guest Post Process

1

Find sites

Search: "write for us" digital marketing, or inurl:guest-post.

2

Vet them

Check relevance, real traffic, content quality and spam signs.

3

Pitch

Send a short, personalised email with 3 topic ideas.

4

Write

Original, useful and well structured (1,000+ words).

5

Add links

1-2 natural links to relevant pages, plus an author bio.

6

Track and follow up

Log URL, date and link type. Follow up politely.

Sample Outreach Email Template

EMAIL TEMPLATE

Subject: Guest post idea for [Website Name]: "5 Excel Skills Every Accountant Needs"

Hi [Editor name],

I am Soham from Disha Computer Institute, where I train students in Excel, data analytics and digital marketing. I regularly read [Website Name], especially your post on [post title].

I would love to contribute a guest article. Three ideas:

1. 5 Excel Skills Every Accountant Needs
2. Excel vs Power BI: Which Should You Learn First?
3. How to Build a Student Dashboard in Excel

Here is a sample of my work: [link]. I am happy to tailor the topic to your audience.

Thank you,
Soham Kore | Disha Computer Institute

Common SEO Mistakes



Keyword stuffing

Fix: write naturally for people and use synonyms.



Buying links

Fix: earn links with useful content and outreach.



Ignoring mobile

Fix: test on phones and use responsive design.



Duplicate content

Fix: write unique pages and use canonical tags.



No tracking

Fix: set up Search Console and GA4 from day one.



Expecting overnight results

Fix: plan for 3-6 months of steady work.

Key Takeaways and Quick Quiz

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Search engines crawl, then index, then rank.
- On-page is what you control; off-page is trust you earn.
- Quality backlinks beat quantity every time.
- Stay white hat and track results in Search Console and GA4.

QUICK QUIZ

- 1 Which link attribute tells Google not to endorse a link?
- 2 Name the 3 stages of how a search engine works.
- 3 What is the ideal length of a title tag?
- 4 Which tool shows if a page is indexed?
- 5 Why is a profile with only do-follow links risky?

Assignment

1

Choose a small business

A local shop, a clinic, a coaching class or the institute itself.

2

Keyword plan

Research keywords: 1 primary and 3-5 secondary for 3 pages.

3

On-page audit

Audit one page with Yoast or Rank Math. Show before and after.

4

Off-page work

Complete 5 submissions (bookmarking, Q&A, image, directory) and log them.

Submit a short report (PDF) with screenshots and your tracking sheet.

Thank You

Questions and discussion

Soham Kore

Disha Computer Institute | dishagroup.in

